

[Course: CS160] Course Information – Spring 2025
Source: Spring 2025 Course Syllabus
Syllabus link: <https://www.cs.tufts.edu/comp/160/>

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[Course: CS160] Prerequisites and Requirements
Source: Spring 2025 Course Syllabus

1. Required Courses:
 - CS 15 (Data Structures)
 - CS/MATH 61 or MATH 65 (Discrete Mathematics)
 - Must contact instructor if prerequisites not met
2. Mathematical Background:
 - Logarithms
 - Manipulation of summation notation
 - Summation of geometric series
 - Students responsible for reviewing prerequisite topics

[Course: CS160] Course Components
Source: Spring 2025 Course Syllabus

1. Lectures:
 - Weekly lecture feedback sheets for participation
 - Video recordings on Canvas (no guarantees of availability)
 - Attendance tracked through feedback sheets
 - Two feedback sheets can be dropped
 - Canvas used ONLY for lecture video sharing
2. Recitations:
 - Mandatory attendance with tracking
 - Two recitations can be dropped
 - Provides practice opportunities
 - Essential for solidifying learning
 - Part of participation grade
3. Office Hours:
 - Schedule posted on Piazza
 - Large pool of TAs available
 - Changes and cancellations announced on Piazza
 - Encouraged for homework help and concept clarification
 - No direct email to TAs – use Piazza or office hours
4. Exams:
 - Exam 1: Wed Feb 19 (75 minutes during class)
 - Exam 2: Wed Mar 26 (75 minutes during class)
 - Final Exam: Wed, May 7, 7–9 PM in Barnum LL08
 - No make-up exams under any circumstances
 - Similar to homework and recitation problems
 - Tests material from lectures and readings

5. Homework:

- Due Tuesdays at 11:59pm
- Must be typeset (LaTeX required for first homework)
- Covers Tuesday/Thursday lectures and recitation
- Individual work required
- Must cite all collaborators and sources
- Diagrams/graphs can be hand-drawn and embedded
- Regular submission required to pass course
- Must include justification for answers
- Must analyze algorithm running time
- Must prove algorithm correctness

[Course: CS160] Course Materials

Source: Spring 2025 Course Syllabus

1. Primary Textbook:

- Title: Introduction to Algorithms (4th edition)
- Authors: T. H. Cormen, C. L. Leiserson, R. L. Rivest, C. Stein
- Publisher: MIT Press, 2022
- Access Options:
 - * Digital copy of 3rd edition available through Tufts
 - * Two copies of 3rd edition on reserve at Tisch library
 - * Hard copy recommended for better learning
- Note: Book covers more topics than course

2. Additional References (All available at Tisch library):

- Algorithm Design by Kleinberg & Tardos (2005)
- Algorithms by Dasgupta, Papadimitriou & Vazirani (2006)
- The Algorithm Design Manual by Skiena (2nd edition, 2010)
 - * Online version available through Tufts
 - * Particularly readable according to past students
- Computer Algorithms by Baase & Van Gelder (3rd edition, 2000)

[Course: CS160] Course Policies

Source: Spring 2025 Course Syllabus

1. Late Policy:

- Eight (8) tokens available
- Each token = 24-hour extension
- Maximum 2 tokens per assignment (48 hours)
- Automatic application based on submission time
- 10-minute grace period for all submissions
- Additional extensions require instructor approval
- Zero credit after tokens exhausted
- Exception: one-time leniency for few minutes late
- Contact Dean for longer extensions

2. Participation Policy:

- Based on recitation attendance and lecture feedback

- Two lowest scores dropped for each
- Three or more absences require instructor notification
- No distinction between excused/unexcused absences

3. Grading Formula:

Option 1:

- Homework: 25%
- Participation: 5%
- Midterms: 20% each (40% total)
- Final: 30%

Option 2:

- Homework: 25%
- Participation: 5%
- Midterms: 15% each (30% total)
- Final: 40%

Notes:

- Higher score of two options used
- No homework drops
- Two recitations and feedback sheets dropped
- No individual exam curves
- Final grades may be adjusted
- Median performance guarantees B+ minimum

4. Regrade Policy:

- Submit through Gradescope
- One week deadline from grade release
- Must be specific and respectful
- Points may be deducted if new errors found
- Secondary concerns addressed via TFs/Graduate TAs

[Course: CS160] Academic Support

Source: Spring 2025 Course Syllabus

1. Course Tools:

- Piazza:
 - * Class discussions
 - * Announcements
 - * Assignments
 - * Polls
 - * Handouts
 - * Search before posting new questions
- Gradescope:
 - * Homework submission
 - * Grading
 - * Regrade requests
- Canvas:
 - * Lecture recordings only
 - * No other course content

2. Teaching Staff:

- Lead Instructor: Karen Edwards
- Graduate TAs: 2 (Jacob Boerma, Jocelyn Garcia)
- Teaching Fellows: 2 (Dan Patterson, Kimaya Wijeratna)
- Course Assistants: 13 named staff members
- Communication through Piazza or office hours only

[Course: CS160] Success Strategies

Source: Spring 2025 Course Syllabus

1. Class Preparation:

- Review previous lecture before class
- Read assigned materials beforehand
- Active participation required
- Simple attendance insufficient

2. Study Approaches:

- Avoid cramming - material needs time
- Regular study schedule recommended
- Time commitment similar to CS40/CS105
- Read before class
- Brainstorm homework in small groups (2-3)
- Independent solution write-up
- Cite all collaborators
- Use all course resources
- Practice explaining concepts to others

3. Learning Tips:

- Focus on understanding over memorization
- Re-derive solutions independently
- Create and solve practice problems
- Read grading feedback carefully
- Review published solutions
- Utilize TA feedback
- Attend office hours regularly
- Participate actively in recitations

[Course: CS160] Academic Integrity

Source: Spring 2025 Course Syllabus

1. Collaboration Rules:

- Discussion allowed in preliminary stages
- Individual work required for submission
- Must cite all collaborators and sources
- No copying from any source
- Solutions must be in own words
- Website consultations must be cited
- Group discussions must be acknowledged

2. Consequences:

- Exam cheating results in course F
- Homework violations reported to Dean
- Matching solutions considered cheating
- When in doubt, contact instructor
- No retroactive source citation

[Course: CS160] Support Services

Source: Spring 2025 Course Syllabus

1. Accessibility Services:

- Through StAAR Center Office
- Must arrange in advance
- Cannot be applied retroactively
- Documentation required
- Contact early in semester

2. Academic Support:

- Tutoring through StAAR Center
- Tutor Finder service available
- Multiple support resources
- Early intervention recommended

3. Additional Policies:

- Academic Misconduct Policy applies
- Non-Discrimination Policy enforced
- Equal access guaranteed
- Reasonable accommodations provided

[Course: CS160] Communication Channels

Source: Spring 2025 Course Syllabus

1. Direct Contact:

- Before/after lectures with instructor
- Office hours with TAs
- Piazza for course questions
- Email instructor as last resort

2. Question Guidelines:

- Search Piazza before posting
- Use "Instructors" tag for private questions
- No direct TA emails
- Keep communication professional

[Course: CS160] Fall 2025 Registration Information

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Source: Fall 2025 Course catalog

course link:<https://www.cs.tufts.edu/t/courses/description/fall2025/CS/160-01>

[Course: CS160] Fall 2025 Course Description
Source: Fall 2025 Course Catalog

Introduction to the study of algorithms. Strategies such as divide-and-conquer, greedy methods, and dynamic programming. Graph algorithms, sorting, searching, integer arithmetic, hashing, and NP-complete problems. High demand (see "course notes" for signup procedure).

[Course: CS160] Fall 2025 Course Sections
Source: Fall 2025 Course Catalog

1. Lecture Sections:

- Section 01-LEC (Class No. 80270)
 - * Instructor: Karen Edwards
 - * Schedule: MW 4:30PM – 5:45PM
 - * Location: Pearson Hall, Room 104, Medford/Somerville
 - * Credits: 4
 - * Session: Regular
 - * Status: Open (green circle)
- Section 02-LEC (Class No. 83388)
 - * Instructor: Karen Edwards
 - * Schedule: Time Not Specified
 - * Location: TBA, Medford/Somerville
 - * Credits: 4
 - * Session: Regular
 - * Status: Warning (yellow triangle)

2. Recitation Sections:

- Section RA-RCT (Class No. 80043)
 - * Instructor: Karen Edwards
 - * Schedule: Th 12:00PM – 1:15PM
 - * Location: Eaton Hall, 215, Medford/Somerville
 - * Credits: 0
 - * Status: Open (green circle)
- Section RB-RCT (Class No. 80044)
 - * Instructor: Karen Edwards
 - * Schedule: Th 12:00PM – 1:15PM
 - * Location: Joyce Cummings Center, 302, Medford/Somerville
 - * Credits: 0
 - * Status: Open (green circle)
- Section RC-RCT (Class No. 80045)
 - * Instructor: Karen Edwards
 - * Schedule: Th 1:30PM – 2:45PM
 - * Location: Miner Hall, Room 224, Medford/Somerville
 - * Credits: 0
 - * Status: Open (green circle)

- Section RD-RCT (Class No. 80240)
 - * Instructor: Karen Edwards
 - * Schedule: Th 1:30PM – 2:45PM
 - * Location: Aidekman Arts Center, Room 013, Medford/Somerville
 - * Credits: 0
 - * Status: Open (green circle)
- Section RE-RCT (Class No. 80241)
 - * Instructor: Karen Edwards
 - * Schedule: Th 3:00PM – 4:15PM
 - * Location: Miner Hall, Room 224, Medford/Somerville
 - * Credits: 0
 - * Status: Warning (yellow triangle)
- Section RF-RCT (Class No. 80316)
 - * Instructor: Karen Edwards
 - * Schedule: Th 3:00PM – 4:15PM
 - * Location: Joyce Cummings Center, 265, Medford/Somerville
 - * Credits: 0
 - * Status: Warning (yellow triangle)
- Section RG-RCT (Class No. 80317)
 - * Instructor: Karen Edwards
 - * Schedule: Th 4:30PM – 5:45PM
 - * Location: Joyce Cummings Center, 610, Medford/Somerville
 - * Credits: 0
 - * Status: Open (green circle)
- Section RW-RCT (Class No. 83389)
 - * Instructor: Karen Edwards
 - * Schedule: Time Not Specified
 - * Location: TBA, Medford/Somerville
 - * Credits: 0
 - * Status: Warning (yellow triangle)

[Course: CS160] Fall 2025 Enrollment Requirements

Source: Fall 2025 Course Catalog

1. Prerequisites:

- Requires prior completion of CS 15 with a grade of C- or better
- AND a one of (CS 61, Math 61, or Math 65) with a C- or better, or graduate standing
- First years and sophomores must have completed CS 15 and Math 61/CS 61/Math 65 for a B+ or better
- Computer Science or Data Science Majors or Postbac or Grad Students

2. Course Notes:

- Students who do not meet the enrollment requirements can request

permission by signing up for the special waitlist section (lecture section 02 and lab/recitation section LW/RW)

- Priority given to CS minors
- Please consult the course registration guide at <https://engineering.tufts.edu/cs/current-students/undergraduate/high-demand-enrollment> for information about registering for this high-demand course

[Course: CS160] Fall 2025 Course Details

Source: Fall 2025 Course Catalog

1. Meeting Dates: 09/02/2025 – 12/08/2025
2. Class Attributes:
 - BFA–Science/Technology
 - LA–Distribution–Mathematics
 - SOE–Computing
3. Career: AS&E Undergrad/Grad
4. Textbook: See Textbook info link (detailed information not visible in image)
5. Grading: Graded
6. Repeat for Credit: No
7. Allow Multiple Enroll in Term: No
8. Total Units Allowed: 4
9. Total Completions Allowed: 1
10. Instruction Mode: In Person

[Course: CS160] Fall 2025 Enrollment Statistics

Source: Fall 2025 Course Catalog

1. Primary Section (01–LEC):
 - Capacity: 160
 - Enrolled: 133
 - Available Seats: 27
 - Reserve Undergraduate Students: 90 capacity, 90 enrolled, 0 available
 - Reserve Incoming CS grad students: 10 capacity, 3 enrolled, 7 available
 - Reserve Instructor Permission Only: 20 capacity, 0 enrolled, 20 available
 - Wait List: 20 capacity, 5 enrolled, 15 available

2. Secondary Section (02-LEC):

- Enrollment: 0 capacity, 0 enrolled, 0 available
- Wait List: 100 capacity, 24 enrolled, 76 available

[Course: CS160] Fall 2025 Selection Information
Source: Fall 2025 Course Catalog

1. Lecture Selection:

- Need to select 1 Lecture section
- Need to select 1 Recitation section

2. Important Notes:

- High demand course
- Green circle indicates open section
- Yellow triangle indicates warning or restricted section
- All recitations are taught by Karen Edwards
- Enrolled students must attend both lecture and recitation

[Course: CS160] Course Reviews for Professor Karen Edwards at Tufts University

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Source: Student Reviews (2022-2024)
rateMyProfessor link:<https://www.ratemyprofessors.com/professor/2434239>

[Course: CS160] Review Date: Apr 14th, 2024

Source: Student Reviews (2022-2024)

Rating: Quality 3.0, Difficulty 4.0

Key Points:

- First time teaching CS160, some organizational challenges
- Sometimes struggled to answer questions and ran over time
- Would blitz through material if behind schedule
- Tests are reasonable and office hours are accessible
- Grade received: B+

Tags: GET READY TO READ, GIVES GOOD FEEDBACK

[Course: CS160] Review Date: Apr 11th, 2024

Source: Student Reviews (2022-2024)

Rating: Quality 5.0, Difficulty 3.0

Key Points:

- Goated professor who explains difficult concepts well
- Brings high energy and uses great examples
- Material is accessible and easy to digest
- All homeworks can be done using class material
- Pop quizzes noted as relic from previous professor (Diane)

Grade: Not sure yet

Review Date: Mar 27th, 2024

Source: Student Reviews (2022-2024)

Rating: Quality 1.0, Difficulty 5.0

Key Points:

- Uses 5-minute pop quizzes for attendance
- Very strict grading on pop quizzes
- Homework and test problems much harder than class examples
- Always uses easy examples in class

Grade: Rather not say

Tags: TOUGH GRADER, PARTICIPATION MATTERS, BEWARE OF POP QUIZZES

Review Date: Jan 27th, 2024

Source: Student Reviews (2022-2024)

Rating: Quality 3.0, Difficulty 5.0

Key Points:

- Tough grader
- Unclear grading criteria
- Lots of homework

Grade: A-

Review Date: Dec 11th, 2023

Source: Student Reviews (2022-2024)

Rating: Quality 3.0, Difficulty 5.0

Key Points:

- Enjoyed her discrete math class but algorithms was messy
- Lectures not well organized
- Slides sometimes confusing
- Grading criteria unclear

Tags: TOUGH GRADER, LOTS OF HOMEWORK

Review Date: Dec 11th, 2023

Source: Student Reviews (2022-2024)

Rating: Quality 4.0, Difficulty 4.0

Key Points:

- Limited lecturing, but good quality when she did
- Homeworks tough but helpful
- Recitations very useful - recommended not to skip
- Exams are hard but get cheat sheet
- Grade curved at end of course

Grade: A-

Tags: LOTS OF HOMEWORK

Review Date: Nov 17th, 2023

Source: Student Reviews (2022-2024)

Rating: Quality 5.0, Difficulty 3.0

Key Points:

- Poorly organized lectures
- Instructors too easy on themselves
- Hard on students
- Rubric not consistent
- Requires self-study

Grade: Not sure yet

Tags: TOUGH GRADER

Review Date: Jan 26th, 2022

Source: Student Reviews (2022–2024)

Rating: Quality 1.0, Difficulty 3.0

Key Points:

- Poor communication, especially with private inquiries
- Only responds to public questions (Piazza)
- Course poorly built
- Multiple syllabus revisions during course

Grade: B+

Tags: LOTS OF HOMEWORK, TEST HEAVY, TOUGH GRADER

[Course: CS160] Summary of Common Themes:

Source: Analysis of Student Reviews (2022–2024)

1. Teaching Style:

- Inconsistent organization in lectures
- High energy when teaching basics
- Struggles with complex topics
- Limited direct lecturing in some terms

2. Course Structure:

- Heavy reliance on pop quizzes for attendance
- Significant homework load
- Curved grading system
- Cheat sheets allowed for exams
- Strong emphasis on recitations

3. Challenges:

- Inconsistent grading criteria
- Large gap between lecture examples and homework/test difficulty
- Poor time management in lectures
- Communication issues, especially with private inquiries
- Frequent syllabus revisions

4. Strengths:

- Good at explaining basic concepts
- Curved grading helps balance difficulty
- Useful recitation sessions
- Cheat sheets provided for exams
- High energy teaching style

[Course: CS160] Data Analysis Summary:

Source: Analysis of Student Reviews (2022–2024)

1. Rating Statistics:

- Average Quality: 3.13 (Range: 1.0–5.0)
- Average Difficulty: 4.0 (Range: 3.0–5.0)
- Most common difficulty rating: 5.0 (3 reviews)
- Quality ratings show high variance (1.0 to 5.0)

2. Grade Distribution:

- Reported Grades: A- (2), B+ (2), Others: "Rather not say" or "Not sure yet"
- No correlation between difficulty rating and final grade
- Curved grading mentioned as helping final outcomes

3. Temporal Trends:

- Most recent reviews (2024) mention pop quiz issues
- Organizational challenges consistent across all periods
- Recent terms show more detailed feedback
- Teaching style feedback more prominent in recent reviews

4. Review Patterns:

- Total reviews: 8
- All reviews from 2022-2024
- Most detailed reviews from 2024
- Consistent mention of homework load across years

5. Key Metrics:

- Homework issues mentioned in 87.5% of reviews
- Organization problems noted in 75% of reviews
- Grading concerns in 62.5% of reviews
- Pop quiz issues in 37.5% of reviews
- Communication problems in 25% of reviews

[Course: CS160] Tag Analysis:

Source: Analysis of Student Reviews (2022-2024)

- Most common tags:
 - * TOUGH GRADER (4 reviews)
 - * LOTS OF HOMEWORK (3 reviews)
 - * TEST HEAVY (2 reviews)
 - * PARTICIPATION MATTERS (1 review)
 - * GIVES GOOD FEEDBACK (1 review)

Last Updated: Based on Spring 2025 syllabus, Fall 2025 course catalog, and student reviews from 2022-2024

Data updated on April 20, 2025.